

Işéyá

INVESTOR BUSINESS PLAN

The trusted marketplace for Nigerian work.

A mobile-first platform connecting verified workers, employers and recruitment agents — Naira-native, built for how Nigeria actually hires.

220M+

Nigerians — the market Işéyá serves

80%

of work is informal, casual or self-employed

120M+

mobile internet connections

Company Işéyá, operated by Renowned Technology Limited

Website iseya.ng

Document Business Plan & Seed Investment Memorandum

Status Confidential — for prospective investors only

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Executive Summary

Işéyá is a mobile-first job marketplace for Nigeria — connecting workers with employers and recruitment agents across casual, part-time, remote, freelance and full-time work. It replaces the offline, middleman-driven hiring that dominates Africa's largest informal economy with a fast, verified and Naira-native platform.

Hiring in Nigeria still runs on word of mouth, WhatsApp groups and informal middlemen who charge job seekers one to two months of wages with no accountability. Meanwhile the enabling rails — smartphones, mobile money and digital KYC — are finally ubiquitous. Işéyá brings this entire flow online: workers build verified profiles and apply in a few taps; employers post jobs and hire with confidence; agents run recruitment for multiple clients from a single dashboard.

The product is already built and live. It includes role-based experiences for applicants, employers and agents; identity verification with a review workflow; tiered subscriptions billed in Naira through Paystack and Flutterwave; an admin console with granular role-based access control; automated transactional email; a support and live-chat system; Facebook auto-posting for reach; and a Job-Aid programme that monetises the job-seeker side with premium career support.

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SIDES OF THE
MARKETPLACE: WORKERS,
EMPLOYERS, AGENTS

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PAYMENT RAILS LIVE:
PAYSTACK & FLUTTERWAVE

Live

PRODUCT BUILT &
OPERATING TODAY

THE OPPORTUNITY

Nigeria has 220M+ people, a median age of ~18, and over 120M mobile internet connections. Roughly 80% of employment is informal. Even a small share of formalised, monetised hiring represents a large and defensible revenue base — and Işéyá is positioned to own the trust layer for it.

THE ASK

Işéyá is raising a **seed round of [\$XXX,000 / ₦XXX million]** to fund an 18-month runway. The plan targets three Nigerian cities, 10,000 verified workers, 1,000 paying employers and positive contribution margin — the foundations of a category-defining Nigerian hiring platform.

Bracketed figures are placeholders for the founders to confirm before circulation.

Company Overview

Işéyá is a job marketplace platform operated by **Renowned Technology Limited**, connecting workers with employers across Nigeria. The name — Yoruba for "work" — reflects the mission: to make honest work easy to find and easy to fill, for everyone from a house cleaner in Lagos to a software engineer working remotely.

MISSION

To connect every Nigerian to dignified work through a platform that is trusted, transparent and built for local realities.

VISION

To become the default hiring layer for Africa's informal and semi-formal economy — the first place workers, employers and agents go to get things done.

What Işéyá does today

- **For job seekers:** browse and apply to jobs for free, build a profile, get verified, track applications, negotiate offers, and optionally subscribe to Job-Aid for hands-on career support.
- **For employers:** post jobs, access verified applicants, manage a hiring pipeline, run interviews, extend and negotiate offers, and reach beyond the platform via social auto-posting.
- **For agents:** operate as recruitment middlemen the right way — managing jobs and candidates for multiple clients from one dashboard, using a credit or subscription model.

Core values

TRUST FIRST

Verification, ratings and accountability are built into the product, not bolted on.

LOCAL BY DESIGN

Naira-native pricing, 36 states and 774 LGAs, neighbourhood-level filters, and payment methods Nigerians already use.

MOBILE-FIRST

Optimised for the smartphone-only majority, lightweight enough for real-world data conditions.

FAIR ECONOMICS

Free to seek work; employers and agents pay for reach and tooling — never exploitative placement fees.

Casual work in Nigeria is stuck offline.

The largest labour market in Africa runs on informal networks, not infrastructure. That creates friction, cost and risk on every side of the transaction.

FOR WORKERS

- Jobs are found through word of mouth, WhatsApp groups and physical noticeboards — slow, narrow and unreliable.
- Informal middlemen charge **one to two months of wages** as placement fees, often with no job delivered and no recourse.
- No verifiable identity or reputation means honest workers can't prove they're trustworthy.

FOR EMPLOYERS

- No reliable way to verify who they're hiring, especially for in-home and on-site roles.
- Sourcing is manual and time-consuming; quality is a gamble.
- Existing job boards are built for formal, white-collar roles and priced for enterprises — not the SMEs and households that drive casual hiring.

FOR THE MARKET

- No trusted, structured, mobile-native place where supply and demand for everyday work actually meet.
- Payments, identity and accountability are fragmented across informal channels.

THE GAP

The rails for digital hiring — smartphones, mobile money and KYC — are finally in place. What's missing is a trusted marketplace that ties them together for the 80% of work that is informal. That is the gap Işéyá fills.

A mobile-first marketplace for Nigerian work.

Işéyá brings the entire hiring flow online — discovery, verification, application, interview, offer and payment for premium services — in one Naira-native platform designed for how Nigeria hires.

Role-based experiences

ROLE	WHAT THEY GET
Applicant	Free browsing and applications, profile and CV, identity verification badge, application tracking, counter-offers, job-type and category preferences with alerts.
Employer	Instant job posting across organised sectors, verified applicant access, pipeline management, interviews, offers and counter-offers, Facebook auto-posting on premium tiers.
Agent	Employer-grade tooling to recruit for multiple clients; credit-based or subscription posting; full pipeline control across many employers from one dashboard.
Admin	Console with granular role-based permissions to manage users, jobs, verification, subscriptions, Job-Aid, promotions, chats and transactions.

What makes it work in Nigeria

VERIFICATION & TRUST

Government-ID verification (NIN, Voter's Card, Driver's License, Passport) plus a selfie check, reviewed by the team. Verified workers get a badge, priority listing and materially higher hiring odds.

NAIRA-NATIVE PAYMENTS

All pricing in ₦, paid via Paystack or Flutterwave — cards, bank transfer, USSD and mobile money. No FX friction for SMEs.

HYPER-LOCAL COVERAGE

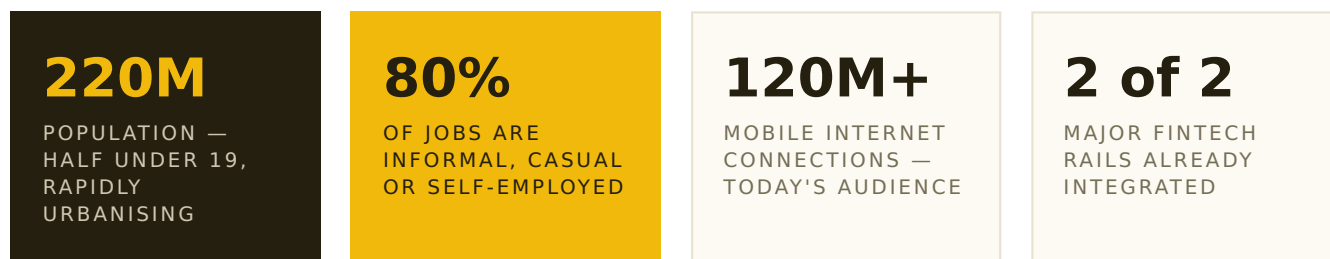
36 states, 774 LGAs and neighbourhood-level filters, so hiring matches how people actually live and work.

JOB-AID FOR SEEKERS

Optional premium career support — personalised recommendations, referrals, AI CV refining, interview booking, verification and priority support — monetising the demand side too.

Africa's largest informal labour market is going online.

Nigeria combines enormous scale, a young mobile-native population and — for the first time — the digital rails needed to formalise everyday hiring.



Why now

- **Smartphone saturation:** the largest mobile internet base on the continent, growing fast.
- **Fintech maturity:** Paystack and Flutterwave have normalised digital payments for SMEs and consumers.
- **Digital identity:** NIN and other KYC instruments make trustworthy verification possible at scale.
- **Behaviour shift:** a generation that already lives on mobile expects to find work the same way it finds everything else.

Market sizing (illustrative framework)

LAYER	DEFINITION	SCALE
TAM	Nigeria's informal & semi-formal workforce and the businesses that hire them	80%+ of ~70M+ workers
SAM	Mobile-internet-enabled workers, SMEs, households & agents hiring casually / part-time / remote	120M+ connected
SOM (18 mo)	Verified workers & paying employers reachable across the first three cities	10k workers · 1k employers

Figures above are directional and intended to frame the opportunity; they are not audited market estimates. The near-term serviceable target is anchored to the company's own 18-month operating milestones.

Tiered subscriptions, Naira-native.

Işeyá monetises both sides of the marketplace. Employers and agents pay to post and hire; job seekers can pay for premium career support. Recurring subscriptions form the revenue core, with add-on credits driving expansion revenue.

Employer & agent subscriptions

FREE #0 Browse, profile, 1 active job. Onboards every employer.	STANDARD #5k/mo 5 jobs, applicant inbox, basic verification badges.	PREMIUM · POPULAR #15k/mo Unlimited jobs, agent recommender, Facebook auto-posting.	ENTERPRISE Custom Hiring companies, bulk credits, API & dedicated team.
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Pricing shown reflects current plan structure and is configurable by the platform; promotional discounts may apply.

Revenue streams

STREAM	DESCRIPTION	TYPE
Employer subscriptions	Monthly recurring plans (Standard, Premium, Enterprise) for posting and hiring.	Recurring
Agent monetisation	Job-posting credits and subscription plans for recruitment agents.	Recurring + usage
Job-Aid (seekers)	Premium career-support plans for job seekers (Casual, Smart, Remote, Freelance, Corporate).	Recurring
Verification fees	Identity verification for applicants (valid 30 days), a paid trust product.	Transactional
Add-ons	Interview credits, agent credit packs and featured listings.	Expansion
Promotions	On-platform promotional placements and sponsored banners.	Ancillary

WHY THE MODEL COMPOUNDS

Free posting onboards the entire employer base, verification builds a defensible trust graph, and both sides convert to recurring revenue as they get value. Add-on credits let the highest-intent users spend more, lifting ARPU without raising base prices.

What's already built.

Işéyá is not a concept — it is a live, production platform. Capital accelerates growth on top of a working product, not a prototype.

Shipped & operating

- **Identity verification** with document upload, selfie check and admin review workflow.
- **Role-based access control** across applicants, employers, agents and multi-tier admins.
- **Tiered subscriptions** billed in Naira via Paystack and Flutterwave, with secure payment verification.
- **Job-Aid programme** — seeker plans, per-benefit request flows and admin fulfilment.
- **Facebook auto-posting** to extend job reach off-platform.
- **Email automation** for verification, resets, notifications and lifecycle messaging.
- **Support & live chat** with an AI assistant and human-handoff to admins.
- **Admin console** for users, jobs, applications, transactions, promotions and analytics.
- **Applicant tools** — CV refining, recommendations, interview booking, counter-offers.
- **Secure auth** — email/password with CAPTCHA, Google sign-in and hardened sessions.

Architecture

A modern, cloud-native stack: a React & TypeScript mobile-first web client, an Express (Node.js) API, and a PostgreSQL database. Payments run through Paystack and Flutterwave; transactional email through managed providers. The system is built to scale horizontally as demand grows, with security practices including hashed credentials, server-side sessions and CAPTCHA-protected auth, aligned to the Nigeria Data Protection Regulation (NDPR).

Web

MOBILE-FIRST PWA-READY
CLIENT

API

EXPRESS + POSTGRESQL
BACKEND

NDPR

PRIVACY-ALIGNED DATA
HANDLING

Competitive landscape & edge.

Global and pan-African job boards target formal, white-collar roles; informal hiring is left to WhatsApp, agents and noticeboards. Işeyá is purpose-built for the middle Nigeria actually lives in.

APPROACH	CASUAL / INFORMAL FIT	TRUST LAYER	NAIRA-NATIVE
Global job boards	Poor — formal roles only	Limited	No
WhatsApp / social groups	High reach, no structure	None	Cash only
Informal middlemen	High but exploitative	None	Cash, high fees
Işeyá	Built for it	Verification + ratings	Yes

Our moats

LOCAL-FIRST DESIGN

36 states, 774 LGAs, neighbourhood filters and Naira pricing — hard to replicate by a foreign entrant treating Nigeria as an afterthought.

TRUST GRAPH

Every verification and rating deepens a proprietary trust layer that gets more valuable — and more defensible — with scale.

AGENT NETWORK

Formalising middlemen as productive agents turns a legacy adversary into a distribution channel.

DUAL PAYMENT RAILS

Paystack and Flutterwave together maximise conversion and resilience across cards, transfers, USSD and mobile money.

City-by-city, supply-side first.

Marketplaces win by solving the chicken-and-egg problem locally. İşeyá concentrates liquidity in one city at a time, seeding verified worker supply first so employers find immediate value.

The playbook

1. **Seed supply:** recruit and verify workers in a target city through agents, community partners and referrals — free to join lowers the barrier.
2. **Activate demand:** onboard SMEs and households with free posting; convert to paid tiers as they experience verified, faster hiring.
3. **Enlist agents:** convert existing middlemen into platform agents who bring their own worker and employer networks.
4. **Amplify reach:** Facebook auto-posting and promotions extend every listing beyond the platform.
5. **Densify, then expand:** reach liquidity in one city, then replicate the motion in the next.

Channels

- Agent-led community recruitment
- Social & digital acquisition (incl. Facebook auto-posting)
- Referral loops on both sides
- SME & sector partnerships
- Verification as an on-ramp to trust
- Job-Aid as a seeker-side growth & monetisation engine

18-MONTH TARGET

3 cities · 10,000 verified workers · 1,000 paying employers · positive contribution margin.

Operations, trust & safety.

Trust is the product. İşeyá's operating model is designed to keep both sides of the marketplace safe, accountable and coming back.

VERIFICATION OPERATIONS

A human-in-the-loop review team validates IDs and selfies before badges are granted, balancing speed with fraud prevention. Verification expires after 30 days, keeping the trust graph fresh.

RATINGS & ACCOUNTABILITY

Admin-scored assessments after interviews give employers a reliable signal and give workers a way to build reputation.

SUPPORT

Ticketing plus AI-assisted live chat with human handoff resolves issues and reduces churn.

FRAUD & ABUSE CONTROLS

Report flows for jobs and users, admin review and action, CAPTCHA-protected auth and secure payment verification with metadata and amount checks.

DATA PROTECTION

NDPR-aligned handling: hashed passwords, secure server-side sessions, and controlled access to sensitive verification documents.

AGENT OVERSIGHT

Agents operate within platform rules and tooling, replacing opaque, unaccountable middlemen with a transparent system.

Team.

Işeyá is built by an operating team that has already shipped a full, live platform — combining product, engineering and local market execution.

ROLE	FOCUS
[Founder & CEO]	Vision, fundraising, partnerships and market strategy.
[Co-founder / CTO]	Product and engineering — architecture, delivery and scale.
[Head of Growth]	City launches, acquisition, agent network and partnerships.
[Head of Operations / Trust]	Verification, support, safety and marketplace quality.

Team names and bios are placeholders to be completed by the founders before this document is circulated to investors.

Why this team wins

- Proven execution — a complete, production platform is already live.
- Deep understanding of Nigerian hiring behaviour, informal networks and local payments.
- A capital-efficient build, positioning every new dollar toward growth rather than catch-up engineering.

ADVISORS & HIRES (PLANNED)

Seed capital funds key additions across engineering, growth and city operations, plus advisors across fintech, recruitment and Nigerian SME distribution.

Financial plan & projections.

The model below is illustrative — it demonstrates the shape of the business and the path to positive contribution margin, based on the plan's stated targets and current pricing. All figures are in Nigerian Naira (₦) and should be validated against live cohort data as the company scales.

Key assumptions

- Blended employer subscription ARPU rising from ~₦8k to ~₦10k/month as the mix shifts toward Premium.
- Job-Aid adoption grows on the seeker side at a modest single-digit percentage of active workers.
- Add-ons, verification fees and promotions contribute incremental, higher-margin revenue.
- 18-month operating milestone: 3 cities, 10,000 verified workers, 1,000 paying employers.

Illustrative revenue build

DRIVER	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3
Paying employers / agents (avg active)	450	1,500	4,000
Blended subscription ARPU (₦/mo)	8,000	9,000	10,000
Employer subscription revenue (₦m)	43	162	480
Job-Aid subscribers (avg active)	2,000	8,000	20,000
Job-Aid revenue (₦m)	15	60	180
Verification, add-ons & promotions (₦m)	8	28	90
Total revenue (₦m)	66	250	750

Illustrative P&L shape

LINE	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3
Total revenue (₦m)	66	250	750
Cost of revenue — payments, hosting, verification (₦m)	(20)	(58)	(150)
Gross profit (₦m)	46	192	600

LINE	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3
Growth & marketing (₺m)	(70)	(120)	(240)
People & operations (₺m)	(90)	(150)	(260)
EBITDA (₺m)	(114)	(78)	100

THE TRAJECTORY

Year 1 is an investment phase to build liquidity and trust. Contribution margin turns positive as subscriptions compound and city operations mature, with the business reaching EBITDA profitability by Year 3 in this scenario.

These projections are directional illustrations for discussion, not guarantees of future performance. Actual results depend on execution, pricing, conversion and market conditions.

The ask & use of funds.

Işéyá is raising a **seed round of [\$XXX,000 / ₦XXX million]** to fund an 18-month runway to marketplace liquidity across three Nigerian cities and positive contribution margin.

Use of funds

CATEGORY	WHAT IT FUNDS	ALLOCATION
Engineering & product	Scale the platform, mobile experience, matching and reliability.	40%
Growth & marketing	City launches, acquisition on both sides, brand.	30%
Operations & agents	Verification, support, trust & safety, agent network.	20%
Runway buffer	Contingency to protect the plan against variance.	10%
Total		100%

What this round achieves

3 CITIES WITH REAL MARKETPLACE LIQUIDITY	10k VERIFIED WORKERS	1k PAYING EMPLOYERS	+ POSITIVE CONTRIBUTION MARGIN
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Bracketed amount is a placeholder — replace with the figure and currency you are raising before circulation.

Milestones & roadmap.

PHASE	FOCUS	TARGET OUTCOME
Now — live	Full platform shipped and operating; verification, subscriptions, Job-Aid, agents.	Product-market fit signals in first market.
Months 0-6	Deepen liquidity in first city; scale verified worker supply; convert employers to paid.	City 1 liquidity; early recurring revenue.
Months 6-12	Launch cities 2 and 3; grow agent network; expand Job-Aid adoption.	3 cities live; ARPU growth.
Months 12-18	Densify all three cities; optimise unit economics; scale add-ons.	10k verified workers · 1k paying employers · positive contribution margin.
Beyond	Multi-city expansion, deeper matching, potential mobile app & new revenue lines.	Path to national scale & Series A.

CAPITAL-EFFICIENT BY DESIGN

Because the product is already built, this round is about distribution and liquidity — not proving the technology. That focuses spend where it compounds fastest.

Risks & mitigation.

RISK	MITIGATION
Marketplace cold-start	City-by-city, supply-first playbook; free posting to onboard demand; agents bring pre-built networks.
Trust & fraud	Human-reviewed verification, ratings, report flows, CAPTCHA and secure payment checks; NDPR-aligned data handling.
Monetisation / willingness to pay	Free tier drives adoption; value-led conversion; multiple revenue lines (employers, agents, Job-Aid, add-ons) reduce single-point dependence.
Competition / new entrants	Local-first design, proprietary trust graph and agent network create compounding, hard-to-copy moats.
Macro & FX volatility	Naira-native pricing removes FX friction for users; lean, capital-efficient operations extend runway.
Regulatory / data protection	NDPR-aligned practices, controlled access to sensitive documents, and clear user policies.
Key-person / hiring	Seed funds key hires and advisors; documented systems reduce single-person dependence.

IN SUMMARY

Işéyá pairs a live, production platform with a large, underserved market and a focused, capital-efficient plan. This round turns a working product into a category-defining Nigerian hiring marketplace.

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